

Amira Mostafa

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Professional Summary

Results-driven IT Systems & Network Engineer with a B.Eng. in Electronics & Communications and extensive experience leading network infrastructure architecture, design, and administration across multi-site environments. Proven expertise delivering secure, high-performance solutions spanning firewalls (FortiGate, Cisco, SonicWall), wired/wireless network design, and Windows Server administration, with strong capability in datacenter operations, system optimization, and business-critical uptime. Hands-on experience in Azure cloud administration and networking (VNETs, VPN Gateway, Azure Firewall, NSGs/ASGs), supported by Fortinet and Aruba certifications, recognized for strengthening security posture and improving operational efficiency.

Core Competencies & Technical Expertise

- **Network Security & Firewalls:** Fortinet, Cisco, SonicWall, Aruba, Ubiquiti; IPS/IDS, SSL/TLS inspection; site-to-site & remote-access VPN (IPsec/SSL)
- **Wireless Network Architecture:** Aruba, FortiAP, UniFi; RF planning, roaming optimization; WPA2/WPA3, 802.1X/RADIUS
- **Cloud Platforms (Azure Networking):** VNETs, peering, routing; VPN Gateway/ExpressRoute; Azure Firewall, NSG/ASG, Load Balancer, App Gateway; monitoring and governance fundamentals
- **Security Assessment & Endpoint Protection:** Vulnerability scanning (Kali, OpenVAS); EDR (Kaseya, Datto); remediation validation and incident support
- **Network Architecture & Switching:** LAN/WAN design; VLANs, STP/RSTP, LACP, inter-VLAN routing, QoS; segmentation and performance optimization (FortiSwitch, Aruba, Cisco, Netgear, Ubiquiti)
- **VoIP & Telephony:** Asterisk/FreePBX/Sangoma; SIP trunking, call routing; FXS/FXO gateways
- **Client Support & Documentation:** Root cause analysis; SOPs, RFPs, proposals, training materials; project implementation support
- **Diagnostics & Operations:** Wireshark analysis; ITSM (Zoho Desk/One Zoho); patching, upgrades, monitoring, asset lifecycle management

EXPERIENCE

IT SYSTEMS ENGINEER / NETWORK INFRASTRUCTURE LEAD

Zodiac Light Waves Inc.

Ottawa, ON

April 2023 - Present

- Design and manage secure, multi-site infrastructure supporting business-critical operations, improving overall reliability and minimizing downtime across locations.
- Lead security, optimization, and cloud integration initiatives that reduced recurring incidents, strengthened service continuity, and improved performance through standardization and proactive monitoring.
- Administer FortiGate/SonicWall/Aruba/Cisco firewalls and VPNs, implementing security policies and inspection controls to enhance threat prevention and compliance.
- Architect and optimize wired/wireless networks (FortiSwitch, Aruba, Ubiquiti; IRIS RF planning) to improve coverage, roaming stability, and end-user experience.
- Support core server and voice services (Windows Server AD/DNS/DHCP/SQL; VoIP SIP/SNOM/FDMCS) and resolve complex issues using Wireshark and Aruba UXL.

IT SYSTEMS ENGINEER

Ottawa, ON

KozalT

December 2021 - March 2023

- Supported 1,000+ users across multiple client environments, maintaining SLA-driven service delivery and ensuring continuity for essential systems.
- Improved operational resilience by enhancing security controls and strengthening backup/DR practices, reducing repeat issues and improving recoverability during outages.
- Managed Windows Server environments (multi-DC, AD, DNS, DHCP, file services) and administered Microsoft 365/Azure AD for 20+ organizations.
- Implemented and supported firewalls/VPN connectivity (Fortinet/Cisco/SonicWall) conducted vulnerability scanning (OpenVAS), and developed documentation/training to improve consistency and reduce escalations.

TECHNICAL INSTRUCTOR (REMOTE) – IT & NETWORKING

Ottawa, ON

Freelance

August 2015 - October 2021

- Delivered advanced remote instruction in IT fundamentals, networking, databases, and Oracle administration, translating complex technical concepts into practical, applied learning.
- Developed and maintained structured technical curriculum and assessments (custom labs, assignments, and evaluations) and mentored students through real-world problem-solving using Zoom, Teams, and Google Meet.

IT SYSTEMS ENGINEER

June 2002 - April 2012

Egyptian Nuclear Power Plants Authority

- Delivered enterprise IT systems engineering support within Egypt's national nuclear authority, including infrastructure design, upgrades, and enforcement of platform and security standards for critical operations.
- Developed Oracle-based databases and simulation tools for the El Dabaa Nuclear Power Plant and supported procurement by drafting technical RFP requirements and evaluating vendor proposals.

EDUCATION

BACHELOR OF ENGINEERING IN ELECTRONICS AND ELECTRICAL COMMUNICATIONS

Menoufia University

CERTIFICATIONS

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| • Aruba Product Specialist – Central: Hewlett Packard Enterprise, Feb 2024. | • Aruba Certified Campus Access Associate (ACA) : Hewlett Packard Enterprise, Dec 2023 |
| • Fortinet Certified Professional Secure Networking | • Fortiswitch Administrator 7.2 |
| • Fortinet Fortigate 7.4 Administrator , Fortinet. Issued: Nov 2024 | • NSE 1- 3 Network Security Associate , Fortinet. Issued Apr 2023 |

REFERENCES

References available upon request